Teacher and cover plan — Make the identity piece: pattern and portrait

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 1 · Big question: How can we combine a bold repeating background pattern with a high-contrast central identity subject?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Follow your Week 3 composition blueprint to map your central subject and patterned ground on heavy A3/A4 card.

• Establish crisp figure-ground separation using tonal contrast, outline weight, or a contrasting halo.

• Combine wet and dry studio media with controlled edges.

Studio kit: Week 3 composition plans, heavy cartridge card, graphite pencils, oil pastels/wax crayons, water-based ink/paint washes, black brush pens

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Take out your Week 3 composition plan. Which area of your final card is smarter to map out in light pencil first?

Starter question: Why does combining oil pastel with a translucent ink wash work so well for a patterned background?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Map the central subject and background grid: I lightly sketch my central identity emblem filling two-thirds of the card,

then rule a diamond grid behind it.

Step 2: Build the patterned ground with pastel resist and wash: I draw repeating warm amber motifs in the grid and brush a deep indigo wash across the background.

Step 3: Resolve the central subject with bold tone and contour: I shade the central subject with high-contrast tonal gradation and lock the outer edge with a crisp black brush line.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Large central motif with oil-pastel resist patterned background and bold contour.

Independent: Resolved mixed-media identity piece demonstrating clear figure-ground contrast and pattern rhythm.

Aspire: Resolved three-process identity artwork using tonal counterchange and reverse annotation.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Have hairdryers (staff-operated at a safe distance) or blotting paper ready so background washes dry quickly before final contour work.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review a short studio demonstration of oil-pastel pattern resist combined with central tonal rendering.